

The Pareto Chart

The chart that answers the only question that matters with limited time, where do I aim first.

The Eighty Twenty Rule

Economist Vilfredo Pareto noticed about eighty percent of Italy's land was owned by about twenty percent of the people. That lopsided split shows up everywhere, including problems. Roughly eighty percent of your problems come from about twenty percent of the causes. The exact numbers vary, but the shape holds.

Reading The Chart

It is a bar chart where each bar is a category of problem, sorted tallest to shortest, biggest on the left. A line across the top shows the cumulative percentage. You instantly see the vital few, the tall bars on the left, standing apart from the trivial many on the right.

Where AI Fits

Hand the AI your messy list of complaints or defects and it will categorize, count, sort, and chart it, even drawing the cumulative line. But it only sorts the data you give it. It cannot tell you whether your categories make sense or whether the biggest bar is worth fixing once you weigh cost and effort.

Remember this

A Pareto chart replaces opinion and politics with a clear, visual ranking of where the damage really is.